

PATHSEEKER CAREER PASSPORT

UX Interview and Case Study Checklist

Plan ethical user conversations, synthesize evidence, and present a credible case study without overstating your impact.

BEST FOR

Aspiring UX designers, UX researchers, product designers, and student project teams.

FORMAT

8-page checklist - write directly on a printed copy or duplicate the prompts into your notes app.

Discover what fits you best - then test it with evidence.

01 - BEFORE RECRUITING

Frame the research

A strong interview starts with a decision the team needs to make, not a broad request to learn everything about users.

Decision this research will inform...

Target participant and relevant context...

- ☐ The research question is not leading.
- ☐ The team agrees what is in and out of scope.
- ☐ No sensitive information is required unless necessary and protected.
- ☐ Success means learning, not proving our preferred solution.

What this study cannot conclude...

02 - PARTICIPANTS

Recruit responsibly

Recruit people whose experience matches the question. Convenience alone is not a valid sampling strategy.

Experience			
Recent behavior			
Device or access			
Location or language			

- ☐ Consent language is plain and voluntary.
- ☐ Recording is optional and explained.
- ☐ Compensation is fair for time and location.
- ☐ Participant contact data has a deletion plan.
- ☐ Accessibility or language support is offered.

03 - CONVERSATION

Use an interview guide

Ask about specific past behavior before asking for opinions about a hypothetical future.

Welcome	Explain purpose, consent, and no-wrong-answer expectation.	2
Context	Tell me about the last time you tried to...	5
Journey	What happened next? What made that difficult?	12
Reflection	What mattered most in that moment?	5
Close	What should I have asked? May we follow up?	3

My five neutral prompts...

04 - DURING INTERVIEWS

Capture evidence

Separate what the participant said or did from your interpretation. Capture timestamps if the participant consented to recording.

		Low / Med / High	
		Low / Med / High	
		Low / Med / High	
		Low / Med / High	

Bias check

What did I expect to hear, and where might that expectation have shaped my follow-up questions?

05 - AFTER INTERVIEWS

Synthesize patterns

A pattern should be supported by multiple observations or clearly labeled as a single-participant signal.

- ☐ Outliers were retained, not silently removed.
- ☐ Contradictory evidence is visible.
- ☐ Claims distinguish observed behavior from stated preference.
- ☐ The team can trace each finding to notes.
- ☐ Personal identifiers were removed from the share-out.

06 - PORTFOLIO

Build the case-study story

Show the decisions you influenced and the evidence behind them. Avoid presenting a team outcome as your individual work.

Context	User, problem, constraints, timeline, team, and your role.
Question	The decision and uncertainty the research addressed.
Method	Why this sample and method were appropriate; limitations.
Evidence	Key observations, patterns, contradictions, and artifacts.
Decision	What changed because of the evidence and why.
Outcome	Measured result if available; otherwise the next validation step.
Reflection	What you would repeat, change, or investigate next.

The one-sentence case-study takeaway...

07 - REVIEW

Final quality gate

Run this check before publishing or presenting your project.

- ☐ Participant privacy is protected.
- ☐ My role and collaborators are named accurately.
- ☐ The case study explains constraints and tradeoffs.
- ☐ Every important claim has evidence.
- ☐ Screens have meaningful alt text or descriptions.
- ☐ Text contrast and type size are readable.
- ☐ The page works by keyboard.
- ☐ No client-confidential material is exposed.
- ☐ The next learning question is explicit.

Sources and responsible use

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics - Occupational Outlook Handbook

Occupation duties, education, 2024 pay, and 2024-2034 outlook reference data.

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/>

O*NET OnLine

Detailed occupation tasks, knowledge, skills, work activities, and technology examples.

<https://www.onetonline.org/>

CareerOneStop

Career exploration, training, job-search, and local salary research tools.

<https://www.careeronestop.org/>

W3C Web Accessibility Initiative

Accessibility principles, standards, tutorials, and evaluation guidance.

<https://www.w3.org/WAI/>

Important

Career requirements, salaries, and hiring practices vary by country, city, employer, experience, and economic conditions. Use occupational data as a research starting point, not a promise of employment or pay.